

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: January 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at \$68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Before overheads, so this is not profit. Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

- December 2025

Locked

December 2025 is locked (closed 5 Jan 2026). These numbers won't change.
- January 2026

Locked

January 2026 is locked (closed 3 Feb 2026). These numbers won't change.
- October 2026

Incomplete

October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at \$68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages always include all on-costs: super, payroll tax, workers' compensation insurance and leave.

From gross margin to profit

January's jobs made \$58,190 gross margin (35.3%). Technician time not charged to jobs took \$4,620 and overheads \$58,730, leaving (\$5,160) profit before tax ((3.1%) of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 38.4% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	\$58,190
Technician wages and on-costs	\$54,600
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	\$49,980
Technician time not charged to jobs	\$4,620
Gross profit (the P&L)	\$53,570
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	\$58,730
Profit before tax (the P&L)	(\$5,160)
Revenue	\$164,780
Gross margin on jobs, %	35.3%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	(3.1%)
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	38.4%

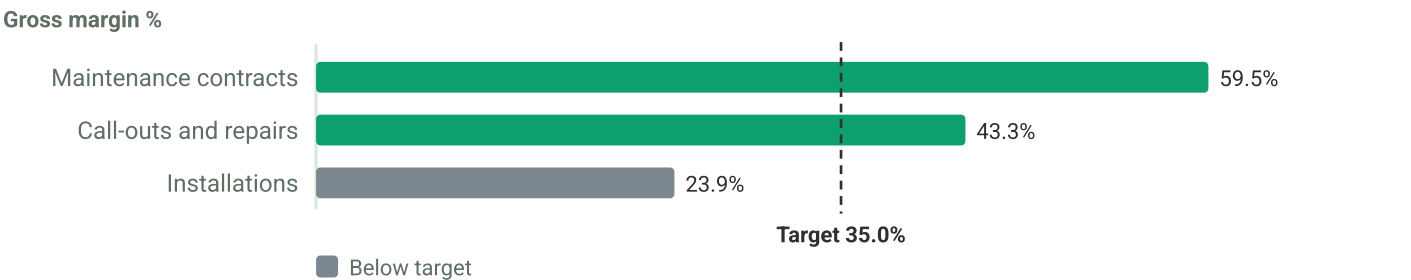
Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, January · All jobs

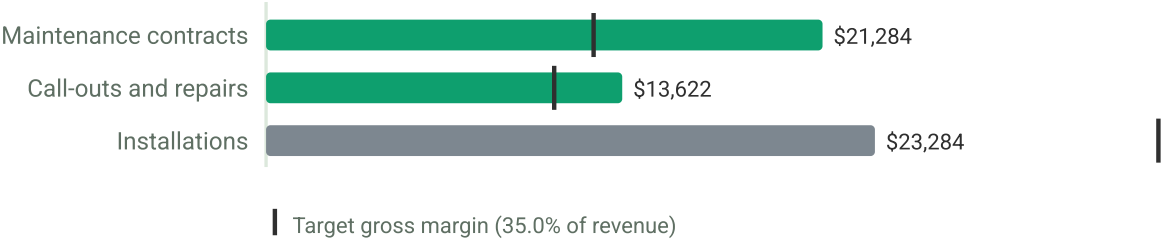
35.3%

December 37.4%

Job gross margin by type of job, January 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

In January maintenance contracts made a 59.5% job gross margin, installations made a 23.9% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 43.3% job gross margin (technician time at \$68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 38.4% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Maintenance contracts: 59.5% gross margin, the most profitable work you do. Installations: 23.9% gross margin, below the 38.4% needed to cover overheads.

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

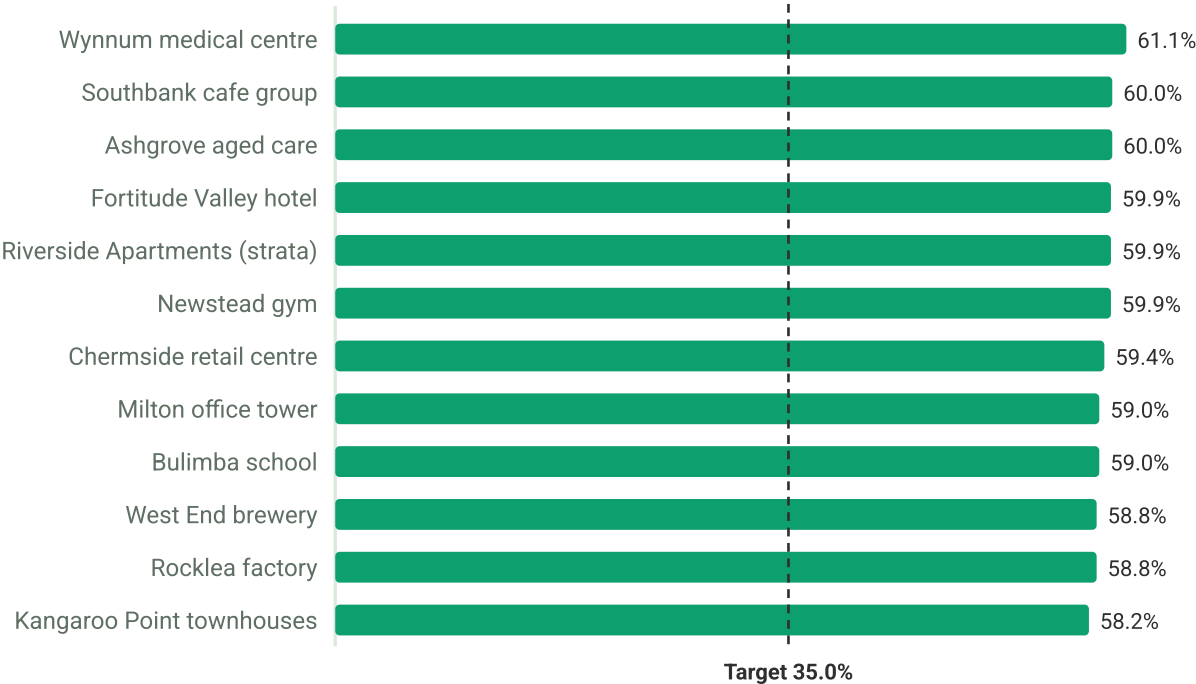
Job gross margin, January · Maintenance contracts

59.5%

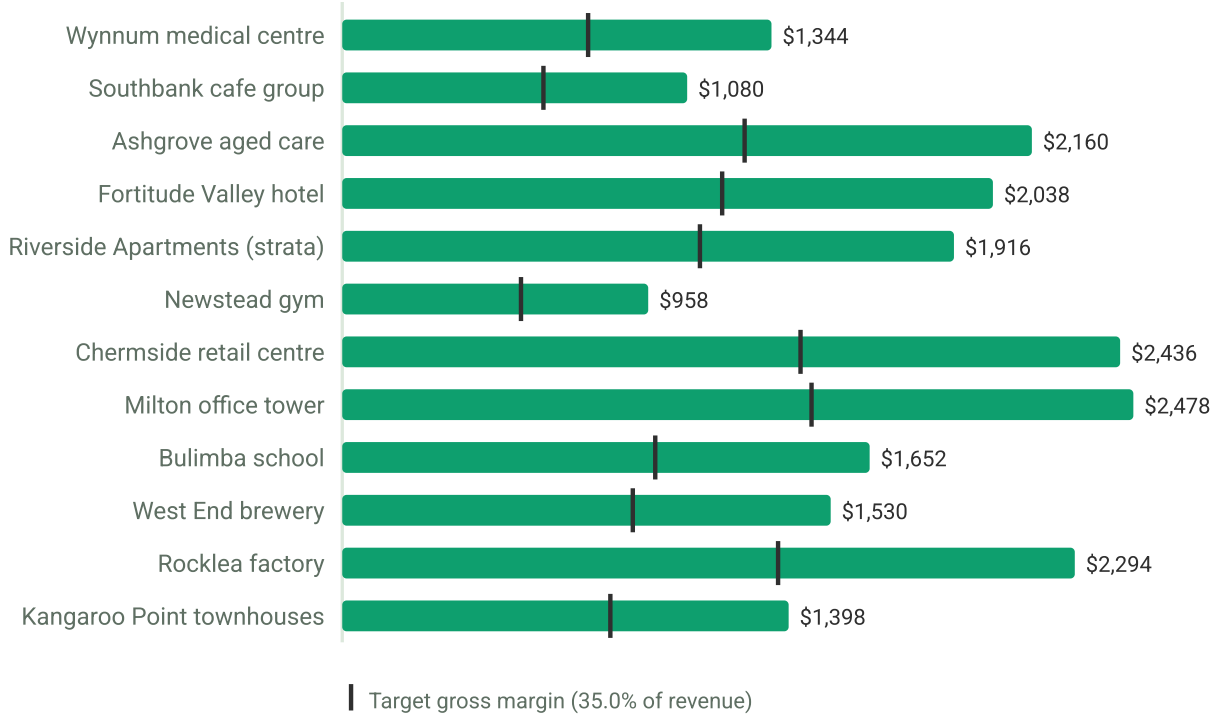
December 59.5%

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, January 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

All 12 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 58.2% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a \$2,400 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

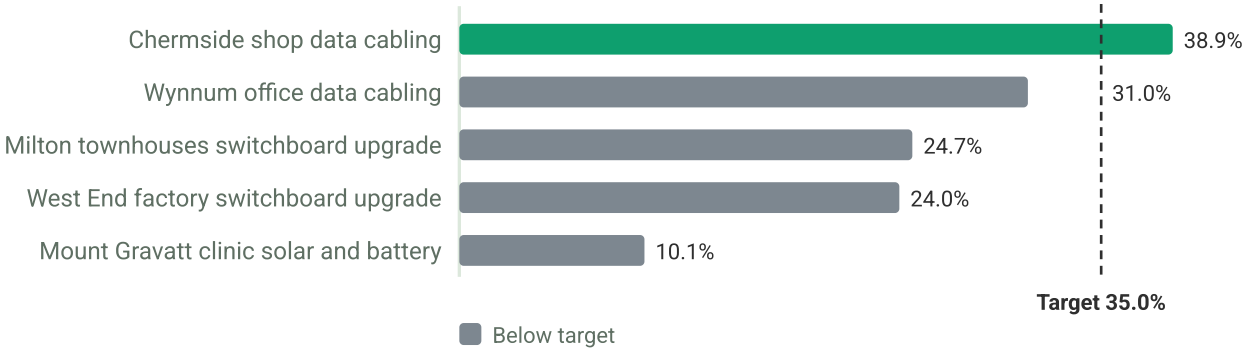
The Kangaroo Point townhouses contract: 58.2% gross margin, 19.8 points clear of the 38.4% overheads need. Maintenance contracts overall: 59.5% gross margin.

Type of job: Installations

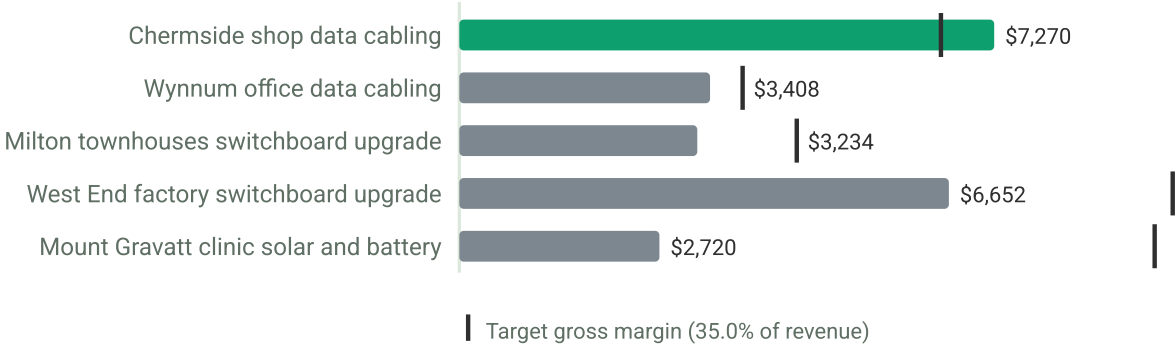
Job gross margin, January · Installations
23.9%
December 23.4%

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in January 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

4 of the 5 installation jobs invoiced in January made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Mount Gravatt clinic solar and battery made a 10.1% job gross margin: 110.0 h of technician time (\$7,480) and \$3,000 of subcontractors on a \$27,000 job. Jobs need 38.4% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Below the 38.4% overheads need: Wynnum office data cabling (31.0%), Milton townhouses switchboard upgrade (24.7%), West End factory switchboard upgrade (24.0%), Mount Gravatt clinic solar and battery (10.1%). Most profitable: Chermshire shop data cabling (38.9%).

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, January - Call-outs and repairs
43.3%
December 43.5%

Technician time charged, January
\$21,171
67.3% of call-out revenue

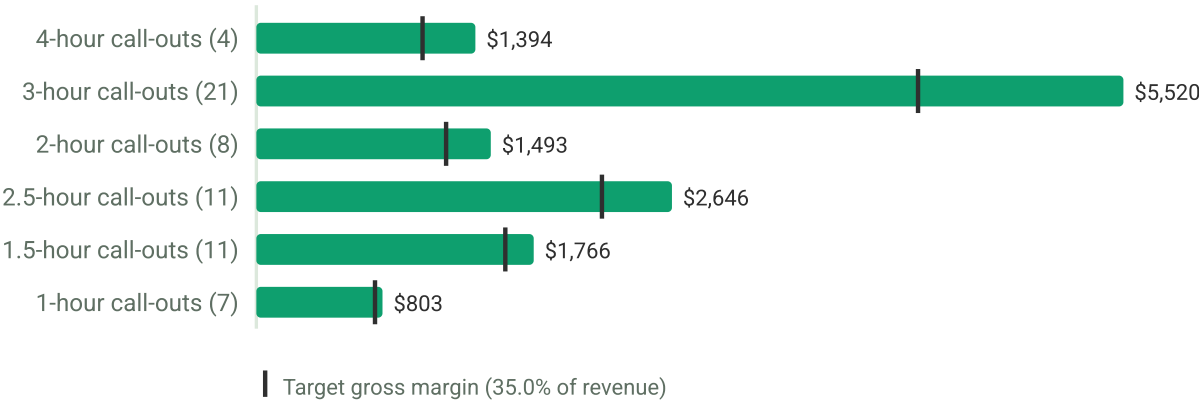
Materials charged, January
\$10,309
\$7,930 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, January 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

62 call-outs in January billed \$21,171 of technician time and \$10,309 of materials (\$7,930 at cost plus 30%), and made a 43.3% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 37.2% to 46.1% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

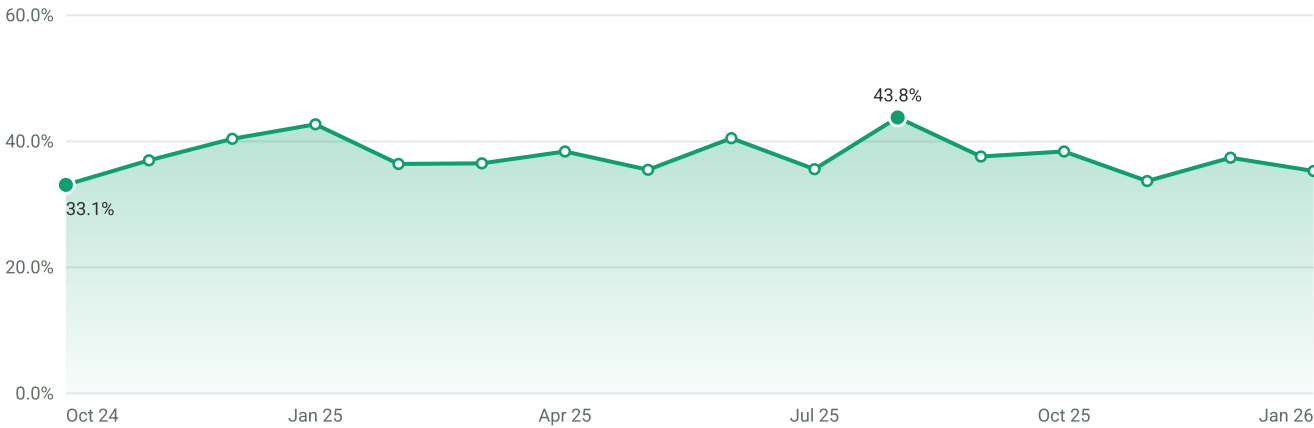
What you'd do about it

Call-outs: 43.3% gross margin, 4.8 points clear of the 38.4% overheads need.

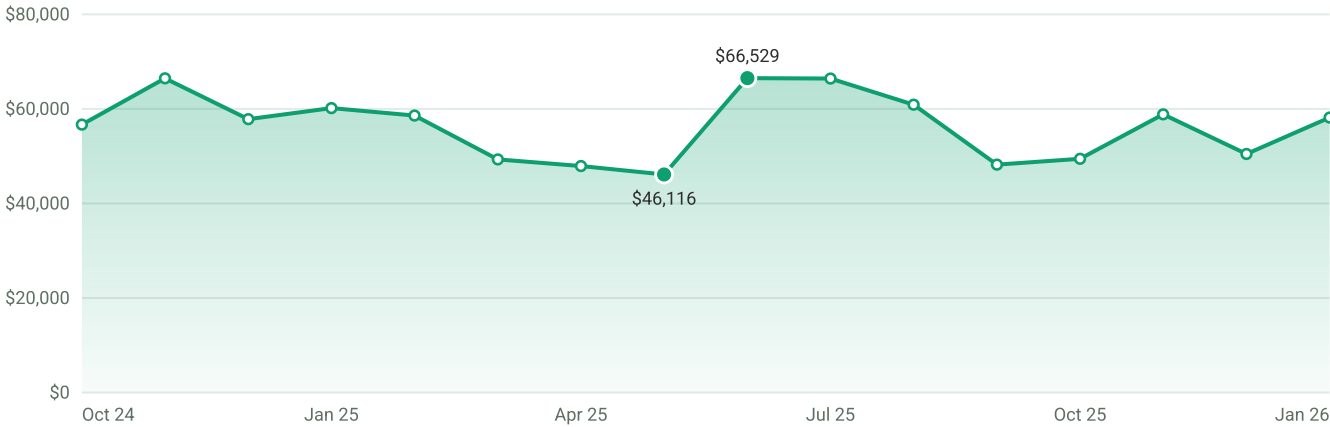
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin \$



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the Excel download.